

Diploma in

PHOTOSHOP



SUMMARY NOTES

Advanced Selections
Lessons 9 & 10

WE WILL DISCUSS IN DETAIL HOW TO EFFECTIVELY CREATE SELECTIONS USING ADVANCED TECHNIQUES IN PHOTOSHOP AND LOOK AT TOOLS SUCH AS COLOUR RANGE AND FOCUS RANGE SELECTION. THIS WILL ALLOW YOU TO MAKE SELECTIONS AS ACCURATELY AS POSSIBLE INSIDE THE SOFTWARE.

1.01	Select Tab
1.02	Basic Tool Types
1.03	Colour Range
1.04	Focus Area
1.05	Select & Mask

ADVANCED SELECTIONS

SELECTTAB

“If you are using the Rectangle Marquee tool, the Elliptical Marquee tool, or the Lasso tool, click anywhere in the image outside the selected area and your pixels will automatically be deselected.”

We have a range of options when using Select Tab:

- 1. SelectAll**—Ctrl+A/Cmd+A
Selects the entire image
- 2. De-Select**—Ctrl+D/Cmd+D
Cancels selection made
- 3. Re-Select**—Ctrl+Shift+A/Cmd+Shift+ A
Redo last selection
- 4. Inverse**—Ctrl+Shift+I/Cmd+Shift+ I
Creates a selection opposite to the current selection
- 5. Grow**
This option will use edge detection to grow your selection among the chosen colour. Works on simpler colour choices
- 6. Similar**
This option will make selections that are the same as your present selection.

TOOL TYPES

Rectangular Marquee Tool allows us to select rectangles and squares.

Elliptical Marquee Tool allows us to select ellipses shapes.

- To make a perfect circle hold down shift key while you click and drag.
- To draw ellipse out from the middle, click and hold alt/option key.

Lasso Tool is a free form drawing tool. It allows us to draw irregular shapes. Simple click and drag wherever you want the selection to go.

Polygonal Lasso Tool draws a point to point line around our subject. It can only draw straight lines.

- To delete a point, you can use the backspace key on your keyboard.

Magic Wand Tool is a very old tool. Nicknamed the 'tragic wand tool'. Uses contrast detection to make selections. Selects pixels similar in colour to the pixel on which you originally clicked on with the tool.

- *The Tolerance option tells Photoshop how different in tone and colour a pixel can be from the area we clicked on for it to be included in the selection. By default, the Tolerance value is set to 32, which means that Photoshop will select any pixels that are the same colour as the area we clicked on, plus any pixels that are up to 32 shades darker or 32 shades brighter.*
- *Contiguous: Only pixels connected to the spot by pixels of the same colour are selected.*

Quick Selection Tool allows us to quickly "paint" a selection using an adjustable round brush tip. As you drag, the selection expands outward and automatically finds and follows defined edges in the image.

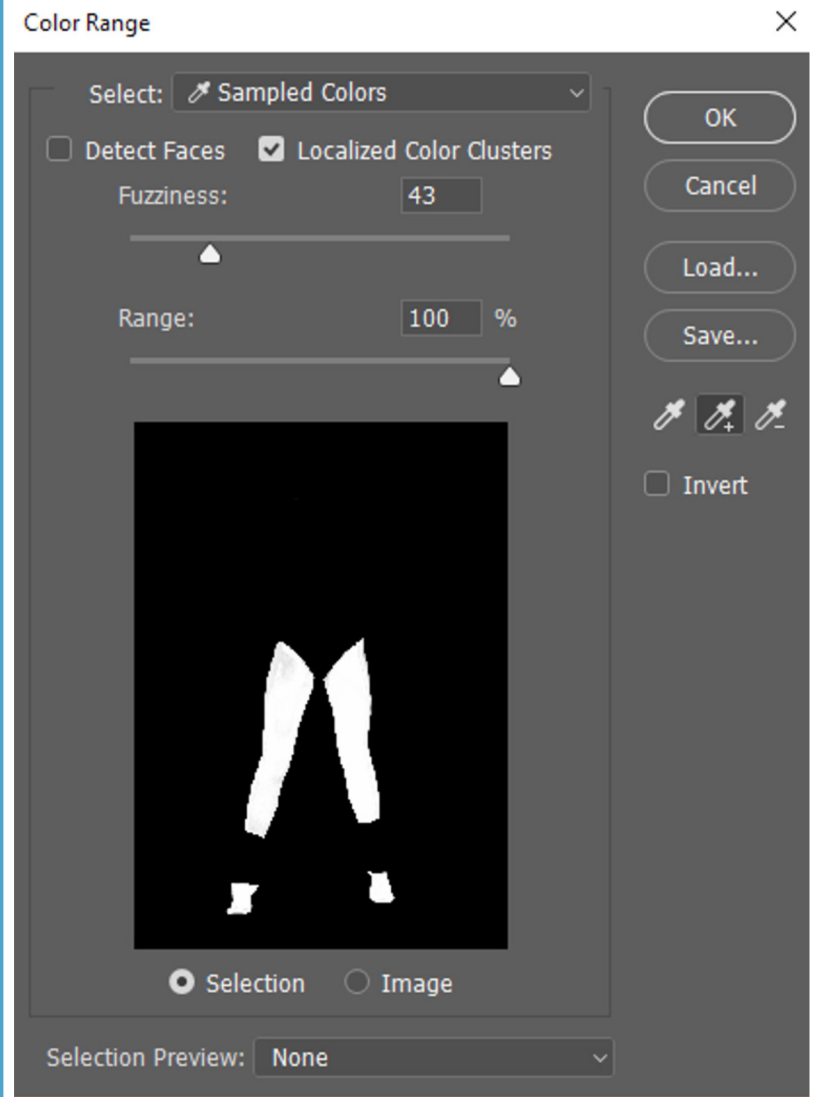
- *Tool uses contrast detection so sometimes doesn't work with blurred or low contrast images.*

All Tool Tips

- We can make our brush larger/smaller and harder/softer using the Options panel.
- We can use our square bracket keys as a shortcut to make brush larger/smaller.
- The Shift key allows us to add to the selection.
- The Alt/Option key will remove from the selection.
- Anti-Alias should be turned on for smoother selections.

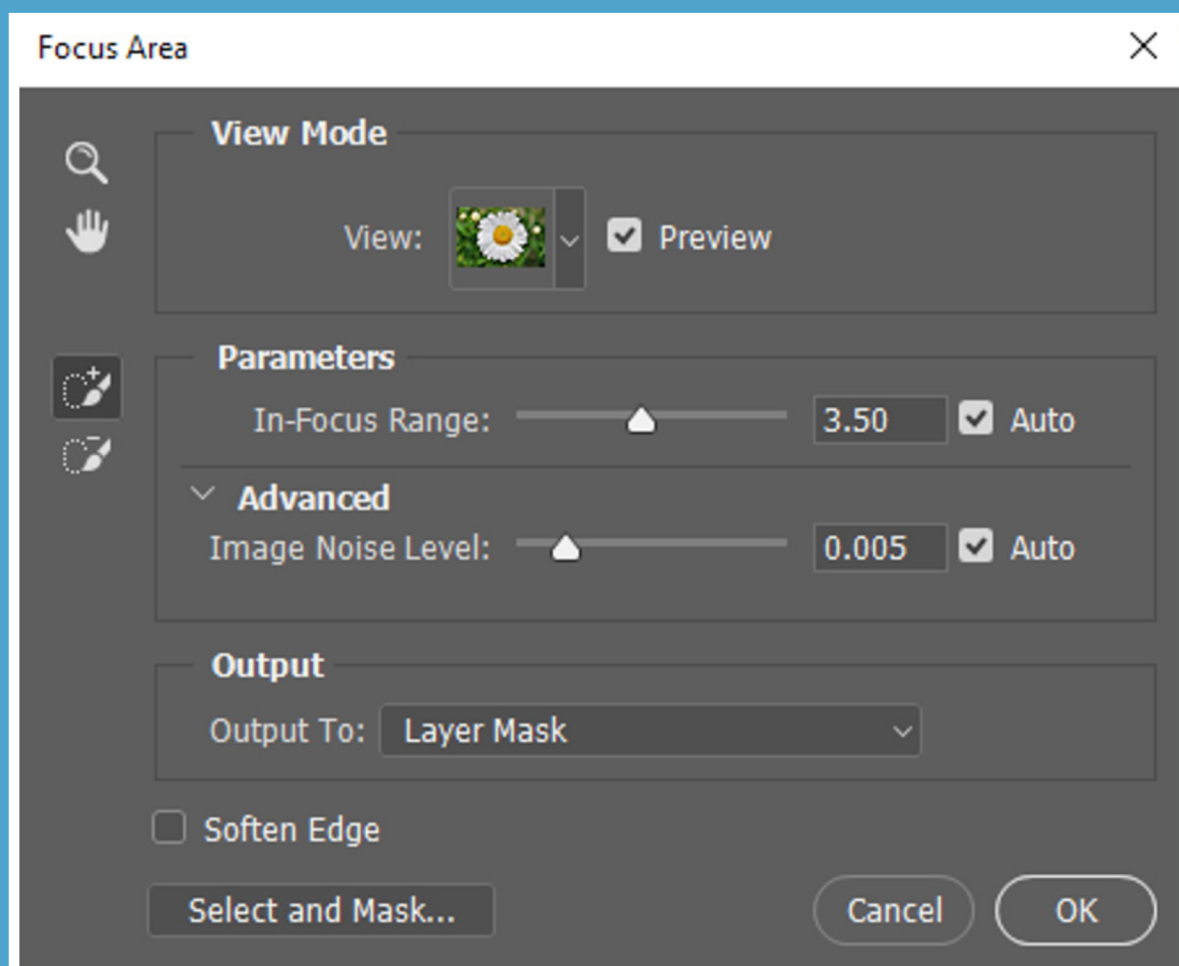
COLOUR RANGE

- The colour range command makes a selection based on a chosen colour in your image.
- The image is chosen with an eyedropper icon.
- The selection can be refined using the Plus and Minus eyedropper icons.
- Localized Colour Clusters helps Photoshop to choose shades/tones close to your selection.
- Detect faces will detect any human faces in the image.
- It is possible to select generalised colours for selection.
- Fuzziness helps select the border of the overall selection.

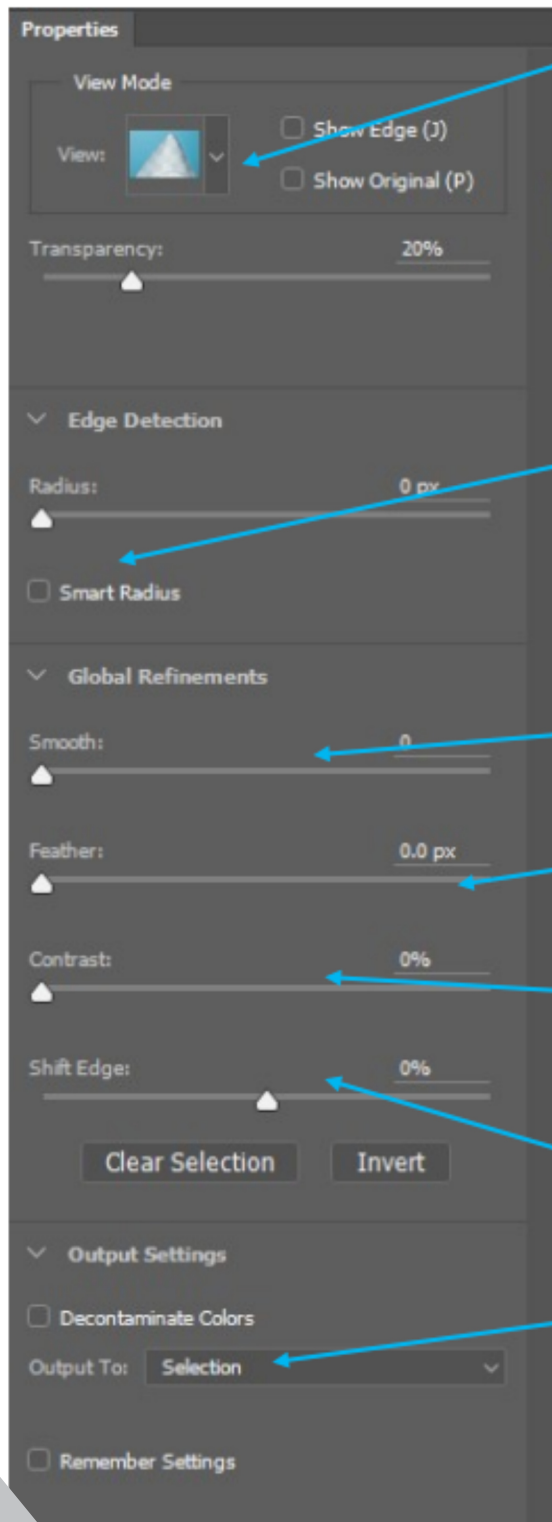


FOCUS AREA

- The focus range command makes a selection based on the image most in focus.
- You can choose different view modes to help define your selection.
- It is possible to use the inOfocus slider to choose how much of the focal image is selected
- You can use the Plus and Minus Quick Selection brushes to edit the finalised selection.



SELECT AND MASK



View Mode allows us to see our selected pixels in a variety of situations. Looking at your selections against both black and white are the most useful options here.

Smart Radius: By turning this setting on, Photoshop will decide whether the selection is hard or soft using an intelligent edge detection algorithm. You can then play with the **Radius** slider until the edges look natural.

Smooth: Makes the selection edges smoother if they are jagged.

Feather: Feathering makes the edges of our selections softer by using partially transparent or differently coloured pixels.

Contrast: This setting sharpens your edge even if you soften it by using Feather or smoothen it by using Smooth.

Shift Edge: This setting shifts your edge. It can either contract your selection or expand your selection.

When outputting using the method shown in Lesson 4, make sure you choose **Selection**.

Step-by-Step Guide to making an Image Composite



ORIGINAL

SELECT & MASK







THANK YOU